بِسْمِ اللهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيْمِ

"in the name of God, Most Gracious, Most Merciful"

Computer Assisted Language Learning

(ENG517)

MODULE 1:

Introduction to CALL

Definition of CALL:

Computer-assisted language Learning (CALL) is an approach to teaching and learning in which the computer and computer-based resources such as the Internet are used to present, reinforce and assess material to be learned.

Aim of CALL:

The main aim of CALL is to find ways for using computers for the purpose of teaching and learning the language. CALL is variously known as Computer-Aided Language Learning (CALL), Computer-Assisted Language Instruction (CALI) and Computer-Enhanced Language Learning (CELL). The first two terms generally refer to computer applications in language learning and teaching, while CELL implies using CALL in a self-access environment (Hoven, 1999).

Introduction of CALL:

New technologies have seen computers become smaller, faster, and easier for the teacher to use (Evy, 1997). At present, well-designed CALL software is readily available to the teacher. · Technologies allow computers to do multimedia applications, incorporating video, sound, and text, and this capacity allows the learner to interact with both the program and other learners. (Felix, 1998). The computer can provide a meaning-focused, communicative learning environment, which serves the purposes of communicative language teaching.

What do we mean by “computer”?

It does not include simply the canonical desktop and laptop devices but also includes the networks connecting them, peripheral devices such as:

- PDAs (personal digital assistants)
- Mp3 players
- Mobile phones
- Electronic whiteboards
- DVD players

What do we mean by "improve"?

It can be answered with respect to a number of different perspectives:

• **learning efficiency:** learners are able to pick up language knowledge or skills faster or with less effort.

• **learning effectiveness:** learners retain language knowledge or skills longer, make deeper associations, and/or learn more of what they need.

• **Access:** learners can get materials or experience interactions that would otherwise be difficult or impossible to get or do.

• **convenience:** learners can study and practice with equal effectiveness across a wider range of times and places.

• **motivation:** learners enjoy the language learning process more and thus engage more fully.

• **institutional efficiency:** learners require less teacher time or fewer or less expensive resources.

MODULE 2:

The Scope of CALL

Initial Stance:

Throughout its history detractors of CALL, and indeed many of its supporters, have criticized the field as being overly "technology driven" at the expense of theory, research and pedagogy (e.g., Egbert & Hanson-Smith, 1999, 2007; Salaberry, 2001). Similarly, others have criticized the field for being too connected to general education rather than focusing on the unique qualities of language learning (Hubbard, 1987).

Full Integration of Technology into Language Teaching:

- At that time, two of the more influential views are those of Chapelle (2001), who links the design and evaluation of CALL tasks to a set of principles derived primarily from the research base of the interactionist perspective of second language acquisition (SLA).
- Bax (2003), who views "normalization" as the defining direction for the field, a state where technology is fully integrated into language teaching.

No need of a Discrete Theory of CALL:

Levy and Stockwell (2006), for example, characterize CALL practitioners and developers as mainly consumers of theory developed for other purposes. This is not universally seen as a problem. Egbert & Hanson-Smith claim that "…educators do not need a discrete theory of CALL to understand the role of technology in the classroom; a clear theory of SLA and its implications for the learning environment serves this goal" (Egbert & Hanson-Smith, 2007: 3).

Technology Deriving CALL:

1. **CALL Emergence:**
   CALL emerged as a distinct field with the beginning of CALL-centered conferences and professional organizations that accompanied the spread of the personal computer in the early 1980s.
2. **Early Work with Micro- computers:**
   Early work with what were then called "microcomputers," such as the BBC computer, Apple II, and IBM PC, began to increase in the early 1980s. This new wave continued to include academic projects involving teams of designers, programmers and language teachers.
3. **Random-Access Laser Videodisc:**
   At about the same time that microcomputers were spreading, the random-access laser videodisc brought a new dimension to language learning in the 1980s. Among the most ambitious undertakings in the history of language teaching was MIT's Athena Language Learning Project, an attempt to bring together interactive videodisc and artificial intelligence (AI) applications to revolutionize language learning.
4. **Artificial Intelligence Improvisation:**
   Although the AI elements were not fully realized, the project did produce some intriguing materials, notably A la rencontre de Philippe, a participatory drama where students play a character trying to find an apartment in Paris (Murray, Morgenstern, & Furstenberg, 1989). Two of the more successful enterprises in business terms have been Auralog (founded in 1987) with its flagship Tell Me More series and

Fairfield Language Technologies (founded in 1992), creator of Rosetta Stone.

The Focus of Research in CALL:

Early CALL research often focused on attempting to demonstrate the superiority of using computers over traditional language teaching.

CALL Design and Evaluation:

- The most elaborate design framework to date is that of Colpaert (2004), which creatively blends engineering principles and pedagogical approaches and is specifically oriented toward the creation of language courseware.
- Another important work in this area is Levy (2002), who categorized the uses of the term design in a corpus of 93 CALL articles from 1999.

Three General Approaches:

Levy and Stockwell (2006) recognize three general approaches here:

- Checklists
- Methodological frameworks
- Applications of SLA principles

MODULE 3:

A BRIEF HISTORY OF CALL- I

CALL in the 1950s and 1960s

Introduction of computer in education:

The first phase of CALL which was called Behavioristic CALL, conceived in the 1950s and implemented in the 1960s and '70s, was based on the then-dominant behaviorist theories of learning. Programs of this phase entailed repetitive language drills and can be referred to as "drill and practice".

Applications used for the language teaching and learning:

PLATO:

The first and most significant applications for the teaching and learning of language at the computer were those used on the Programmed Logic / Learning for Automated Teaching Operations (PLATO) system, developed in 1959 by the University of Illinois working with a business partner, Control Data Corporation. Much of PLATO's first-language learning work was done in teaching Russian using a grammar translation approach.

Simulations:

Simulations are instructional scenarios where the learner is placed in a "world" defined by the teacher. A simulation is a form of experiential learning. It is a strategy that fits well with the principles of Student-Centered and constructivist learning and teaching.

Simulations take a number of forms. They may contain elements of:

- a game
- a role-play
- an activity that acts as a metaphor

Importance of simulations:

The importance of simulations is that they create challenges for learners to explore multiple links and see the consequences of different actions and inputs. This turns the computer-based classroom, or computer-based environment (e.g. a learner at a home computer), into a place where participants learn through the frequent making of errors in a non-threatening way.

CALL in the 1970s

Communicative CALL:

- The second phase of CALL was based on the communicative approach to teaching which became prominent in the 1970s and 80s.
- Communicative language teaching (CLT), or the communicative approach, is an approach to language teaching that emphasizes interaction as both the means and the ultimate goal of study.
- One of the main advocates of this new approach was John Underwood, who in 1984 proposed a series of "Premises for 'Communicative' CALL" (Underwood, 1984, p. 52). According to Underwood, communicative call:

* Focuses more on using forms rather than on the forms themselves;

* Teaches grammar implicitly rather than explicitly;

* Avoids telling students they are wrong and is flexible to a variety of student responses;

* Will never try to do anything that a book can do just as well.

Introducing of microcomputers in Kit form:

In 1975, microcomputers were first sold in kit form (Merrill et al., 1996). This spurred the development of small applications on computers such as the Timex-Sinclair and the Commodore Pet. Many of these platforms were extremely limited by their processing power.

Introduction of Videodisc Technology:

One focus of CALL research during this period was videodisc technology, a high-volume storage system. Unlike videotape, videodisc players featured rapid access to multiple points or 'chapters' on a disk and had better pause, or freeze frame, features along with the possibility of advancing one frame at a time through a set of video or still (e.g. photographic) images or images/pages of text.

Compact Disk Read-Only Memory (CD-ROMs):

The format was initially replaced with Compact Disk Read-Only Memory (CD-ROMs) as they had a greater installed base in personal computers and featured a format that was smaller, more convenient and less prone to warping. **Bush and Crotty (1991)** list several possible advantages of videodisc learning: priority of listening over speaking; through modelling and special efforts to create a low-anxiety atmosphere.

MODULE 4:

A BRIEF HISTORY OF CALL – II

CALL in the 1980s; CALL in the 1990s; CALL in the 21st century

CALL in the 1980s:

In 1988 Pederson made an assessment of the CALL methodologies. The main points of that assessment were:

1. Meaningful Practice
2. Encourage development of language
3. Students differences and difficulties better documented
4. Difference may affect strategies, gains and attitude in CALL
5. Many teachers dissatisfied with the software

In 1980s, the language teachers not only played a role in developing CALL material rather also get involved in using them effectively with students. Also, development of word processing and programs and applications associated to it were developed to use in language teaching process.

These applications include:

Macario:

Gale (1989) describes Macario as an early videodisc program for learning Spanish. It was developed at Brigham Young University and was an attempt to create learning materials by adapting existing materials, in this case a feature-length commercial video. The video was made into an interactive format by adding a pedagogical layer and using it to teach listening skills.

Montevidisco and Interactive Dígame:

Macario is essentially a linear program; in this case, the student follows the course of a film and cannot vary from it. Gale (1989) (also see Stevens, 1992) mentions two similar videodisc programs that featured non-linear opportunities for learning, Montevidisco and Interactive Dígame. These two programs pioneered the idea of learners making greater choices about what is to be learned at the computer.

ALLP (Athena Language-Learning Project):

- The Athena (after the Greek goddess of wisdom) Language-Learning Project (ALLP) (see Murray et al., 1991; McConnell, 1994; Murray, 1991, 1995) began in 1983 as part of a heavily funded long-term Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) project exploring the role of the computer in education.
- Two projects to come out of ALLP merit special mention, No Recuerdos (I Don't Remember) and À la rencontre de Phillippe (Recognizing Phillippe). In both these programs, learners enter into computer simulations that require realistic responses to the main characters.

HyperCard:

- In 1984, Apple Computer introduced a new style of computer, the Macintosh. One of the major innovations in this environment was HyperCard, a materials authoring program that was developed by **Apple Computer**. HyperCard provides an influential metaphor for CALL. On these cards, text, images, audio, animations and video can be added, along with questions and buttons to take users to other cards that might feature further questions, information and /or answers.
- The importance of HyperCard is that it was among the first applications to take advantage of the theoretical hypertext and hypermedia capabilities of computers and allowed teachers and learners easily to create their own CALL applications.

CALL in the 1990s

The World Wide Web was launched in 1992 reaching the general public by 1993, opening up new possibilities in CALL. In the 90s we had Communicative methods, computer networks, hypermedia, Multimedia and the web. The social component of learning Vygotskyan model of language learning was seen as important and we see an emphasis on CMC computer mediated communication.

Hypermedia:

- Hypermedia, an extension of the term hypertext, is a nonlinear medium of information that includes graphics, audio, video, plain text and hyperlinks. It is also related to the field of electronic literature. The term was first used in a 1965 article written by **Ted Nelson**.
- The WWW (World Wide Web) is a classic example of hypermedia, whereas a non-interactive cinema presentation is an example of standard multimedia due to the absence of hyperlinks.
- The first hypermedia work was, arguably, the Aspen Movie Map. Bill Atkinson's HyperCard popularized hypermedia writing, while a variety of literary hypertext and hypertext works, fiction and non-fiction, demonstrated the promise of links.

Multi-media:

- In the 1993 first edition of Multimedia: Making It Work, Tay Vaughan declared "Multimedia is any combination of text, graphic art, sound, animation, and video that is delivered by computer.
- In education, multimedia is used to produce computer-based training courses (popularly called CBTs) and reference books like encyclopedia and almanacs.
- From multimedia learning (MML) theory, David Roberts has developed a large group lecture practice using PowerPoint and based on the use of full-slide images in conjunction with a reduction of visible text (all text can be placed in the notes view' section of PowerPoint).

CALL in the twenty-first century

1. Integration of computing facilities

2. Mobile telephones

3. Online downloading facilities (audio & Video)

4. USB (Universal Serial Bus)

5. Television

6. Program Earworms

As teachers moved away from a cognitive view of communicative teaching to a more social or socio-cognitive view, they placed more emphasis on language use in authentic social context.

• Integrate language skills: listening, speaking, reading and writing

• Integrate technology more fully into the language learning process

Integrative approaches to CALL are based on two important technological developments of the last decade:

• Multimedia CALL

• Web-based CALL

MODULE 5:

MODELS FOR CALL

The introduction of the computer into the classroom (in some cases, some places) has fostered changes to the practice of the teaching and learning of languages and related subjects, such as literature.

Dunkin and Biddle (1974) noted that there appears to be a never-ending supply of models but go on to suggest that there are good reasons for such being the case, 'teaching is a complex activity that reflects many factors.

Problems in Creating CALL Models:

There are problems inherent in any attempt to create a model for CALL in the classroom. One is the expansive scope of what is considered to be within the realm of CALL processes, especially considering the broad definition for CALL that takes into consideration its changing nature: any process in which a learner uses a computer and, as a result, improves his or her language.

The Need for a CALL Model:

The fact that CALL is different from prior approaches and materials is also pointed out by Williams (1998) who argues that the potential for teaching and learning through CALL has not been tapped.

A Model of Current Non-CALL Language Learning:

A general model that includes and expands on Breen's (1998) criteria can also include observations from Dunkin and Biddle's (1974) model. Their model also identified aspects of language learning that might be studied in a classroom.

Dunkin and Biddle's Model in a CALL Context

Various Dimensions:

There are two ways of considering CALL:

- either as a supplementary learning material in which case CALL simply falls under the classroom contexts heading in Dunkin and Biddle's model.
- or as an autonomous process, a kind of virtual teacher.

Computer Functions beyond Traditional Materials:

In Dunkin and Biddle's model, there are aspects that are broadly fixed in both non-CALL environments and CALL environments:

• School, community and classroom contexts

• Product variables of immediate pupil growth and long-term pupil effects

Presage Variables:

Presage variables include Teacher formative experiences, Teacher training experiences and Teaching skills. Sloane (1990) as well as Boyd and Mitchell (1992) take a discourse approach and consider CALL a conversational activity shared among the learner, the machine tutor (i.e. computer program) and the educator/developer.

Context Variables:

Dunkin and Biddle's context variables of Pupil formative experiences and Pupil properties are different in a CALL environment because many learners are likely at least to come into contact with computers, if not CALL, before coming to school. In this way, they are pre-socialized into the idea and methods of learning with computers and develop their own competencies and learning strategies.

Morariu suggested factors for the design of the learning environment:

- Morariu (1988) suggests that CALL materials' developers should decide where in Bloom's taxonomy of questions, learners should be operating. When learners take in information, they use various strategies to make sense of it. These strategies may correspond to levels of questions or thinking outlined by Bloom (1956) in his Taxonomy of Questions.

- J. Morariu commented on the design of learning environments as:

• Goals/Objectives. Stated in behavioral terms, a full breakdown of the con-text and measurable outcomes for the entire instructional environment.

• Structure. The overall organization of the information (e.g. hierarchical with topics and sub-topics, associative with word/icon links).

• Format. Media for presenting the content /data (e.g. text, graphics, animation, audio, still images, motion video).

- Bloom's taxonomy was revised by Anderson and Krathwohl (2001), changing the category titles to verbs and shifting the focus of the upper-level items to: remember, understand, apply, analyze, evaluate, create.
- In a CALL program, it is important to have information structured on a series of levels encouraging readers operating at various levels, at any point, to delve deeper into explanations of the content. It is also important that programs challenge students to perform at higher levels within Bloom's (1956) taxonomy.

MODULE 6:

CALL MODELS PRACTICES IN SLA

Teacher and pupil classroom behavior: activities used in CALL

- Dunkin and Biddle's Teacher classroom behavior is likely to be considered Program interface which also serves to govern learner behavior to the extent that a CALL interface provides different kinds of tasks and encourages learner behaviors such as strategies and role identification.
- The range of tasks and exercises available in CALL can be organized into various taxonomies based on the stated focus of the software (e.g. grammar, vocabulary, fluency), targeted language skills (e.g. reading, writing, speaking and/or listening) or Bloom's (1956) levels of questions and learner characteristics based on age, gender and level (e.g. beginner, intermediate, advanced).

Locus of Control:

Locus of control refers to the continuum between the programs and the learner's responsibility for decisions about the sequence and outcomes of learning, learner interactions and, even, the content of what is taught. Jonassen et al. (1993) see the distal ends of the continuum as representing objectivist and constructivist orientations towards learning. Another view is found in

Chandler's (1984) model in which Tutorial (and in some cases, Games) represents a behaviorist model of instruction in which collaboration and negotiation of meaning are not encouraged.

Observable Changes in Pupil Behavior:

Changes in learner behavior are likely, in many cases, to remain constant but what differs between Dunkin and Biddle's model and a CALL model is what is measured and how it is measured. CALL essentially presents different kinds of language-learning opportunities from those available in a traditional classroom.

Measurement of Language Learning:

Traditional measurement of language learning depends on teacher observations and tests. But CALL programs present many opportunities for different kinds of measurement. More importantly, many CALL programs allow for a learner to obtain immediate feedback on progress, that is, an opportunity to observe their own changes in behavior.

Definition of Virtual Classroom:

A virtual classroom is an online classroom that allows participants to communicate with one another, view presentations or videos, interact with other participants, and engage with resources in work groups.

Characteristics of a Virtual Classroom:

1. **Non-Restricting:**
   A virtual classroom allows both learners and instructors around the world to participate in live classes to collaborate and interact.
2. **Affordable:**
   The low costs of virtual classrooms are considered to be a major advantage. Learners can save money by not having to worry about travel expenses.
3. **Flexible Learning:**
   Online classes also allow for the ability to record class as it happens, including any presentation audio and visuals.
4. **Practical and Proven:**
   Synchronous learning is a learning environment where everyone takes part in the learning at the same time.
5. **Accessible:**
   Virtual classrooms can be used to deliver lectures, or even tutorials online. They are also great options for impromptu meetings and

group projects where members need to check-in on progress and bounce ideas of one-another.

How Virtual Classroom Works?

- Wesley and Franks (1994) suggest the virtual classroom class is 'an electronic classroom which can be expandable in time, space and content.
- They also suggest that the virtual classroom has continuity through time in that it is not limited to conventional academic time segments (semesters, school years, etc.).
- 'Any member of a Virtual Classroom can be in contact with any member of any other connected classroom, whether virtual or physical, so that information and problem-solving capabilities can be mutually shared and reinforced through collaborative interconnection'.

CALL Material Problems:

CALL materials initially suffered from peripheral problems, including a lack of funds, a lack of expertise and a lack of suitable tools in the form of authoring programs that in turn create problems with defining a suitable model. A CALL model that can help guide materials developers and those who assess CALL materials is a noble pursuit, but in the fractured approaches to teaching and learning a language at the computer, it is unlikely a practical model will encompass everything being done in a meaningful way.

MODULE 7:

CALL APPLICATIONS- I

CALL Applications:

This lesson features eight generic CALL applications that together illustrate the breadth of what is available to CALL practitioners. While not intended to be exhaustive, this lesson includes topics on:

- Word processing
- Games
- Literature
- Corpus linguistics
- Computer-mediated communication (CMC)
- WWW resources
- Adapting other materials for CALL
- Personal Digital Assistants (PDAs) and mobile telephones

Word Processing:

- Almost all computers are sold with some version of word processing already installed, usually Microsoft Word. Such programs are widely used in the composition process. Within such word-processing packages, spelling and grammar checkers and simple thesaurus programs are standard tools.
- After much research in the 1980s and early 1990s, attention has shifted away from the influence of spelling checkers and grammar checkers. However, it is an area which continues to merit attention as learners turn away at younger ages from writing on paper to computer-based composition.
- In business, the focus is on the completion of tasks. This is particularly seen in programs that offer spelling correction but do not provide any definitions. Learners – particularly second-language learners – frequently misspell a word then choose the first correction offered, without considering whether it is appropriate or not.
- Word-processing programs also provide grammar support, although such support is sometimes of questionable worth. The grammar checker included with various versions of Microsoft Word.

Games:

- Most educational games, or games used for pedagogical purposes, make use of a form of subversive teaching; learners are unaware of the objectives or, rather, do not share the same objectives as the teacher.
- Learners asked to play the board game Monopoly, for example, may not be aware that they are learning rudimentary concepts about the value of money and real estate, nor will they associate these concepts as part of learning objectives. Similarly, learners are increasingly developers of digital content as online applications allow them to create and manipulate their own and others' media into videos, animations and games (Alexander, 2008).
- Among computers' most popular uses today are as platforms for arcade-style computer games although an interesting development has been the introduction of the Nintendo Wii gaming system which employs kinesthetic skills in doing games; it is a platform rich for development of educational applications, particularly for younger children.

Commercial Quiz Software:

- Particularly online, computer-based games are often in the form of quizzes which test knowledge more than they teach it. Like games,

quizzes are very motivating for learners as they appear to illustrate a learner's progress and give some security against fear of more formal exams.

- A popular quiz format is a cloze exercise, such as one of several test types found in Respondus (http://www.respondus.com), a popular assessment tool used with computer-based course design packages such as Blackboard Vista.
- Other quiz software includes programs to check spelling, listening, speed reading, knowledge of synonyms and antonyms, general knowledge and other English skills.

MODULE 8:

CALL – LANGUAGE GAMES

Literature:

- A work of literature is not a simulation, but it has a high degree of fidelity, or authenticity, in that the learning materials are both extensive and taken from real-world sources. Literature forms the basis of many CALL programs.
- Collie and Slater (1987) offer four main justifications for the use of literature in the language classroom: valuable authentic material, cultural enrichment, language enrichment and personal involvement.
- Literature is a valuable complement to (other classroom) materials, especially once the initial 'survival' level has been passed. In reading literary texts, students have also to cope with language intended for native speakers and thus they gain additional familiarity with many different linguistic uses, forms and conventions, and so on.
- A rich source of content for CALL programs is literature which has come into the public domain and is freely available in digital formats, often with accompanying visual materials. This allows learners to manipulate text and comment on it in interesting ways.
- Collie and Slater (1987) use the term cultural enrichment to refer to the wealth of insights about other cultures (particularly the target language culture) that literature offers.
- In addition to the arguments raised above, there is also the fact that a simple love of literature supports autonomous language learning (Falvey and Kennedy, 1997; Montali and Lewandowski, 1996).

The relationship of literature to computer-based learning materials:

Collie and Slater's (1987) observations on the link between language learning and literature were written with reference to traditional paper-based learning materials they also hold true for computer-based learning materials. In paper-based materials, this is sometimes found to a lesser degree in heavily annotated editions of literary works such as Shakespeare plays.

Hypertext and Literature:

Deegan and Sutherland (1990) note advantages of hypertext for both the study and writing of literature, arguing that texts and non-textual material are essentially fluid and easily manipulated, making it an ideal tool for showing the interconnection of ideas.

Corpus Linguistics:

- Corpus linguistics is an important area in its own right within applied linguistics, but it is also a useful tool for the teaching and learning of language at the computer.
- The corpus in corpus linguistics refers to a body of text. The text can be made up of different examples of spoken or written language or a combination of both. Corpora (corpora - plural of corpus) can be based on simple and brief texts on a narrow topic or run into the millions of words, such as the British National Corpus.
- To access, or make use of, a corpus, one uses a concordance to look at language patterns. A concordance is a tool that looks at individual words (nodes) or groups of words and lists them with their immediate contexts; usually the seven or eight words that come before and after but, in some cases, the entire sentence for each word. The term for describing this approach is key word in context (KWIK).

Corpus Linguistics in the Classroom:

- Both teachers and learners can use corpus linguistics in various ways within the classroom.
- A teacher might collect a set of student assignments and use a concordance program to analyze examples of learners' language looking for typical error patterns.
- Alternatively, a teacher might look through established corpora of texts by native speakers of the target language and find examples for patterns and present these to learners as examples or adapt them into exercises.
- Learners themselves can be trained in the use of a concordance program (St John, 2001) and corpora, then become their own researchers finding examples and developing their own rules for grammatical structures,

idioms and general usage, for example, investigating the differences between the verbs look and see. This approach is often called Data Driven Learning (DDL).

MODULE 9:

CALL APPLICATIONS- II

Computer-mediated Communication:

- Communicating using the computer is often referred to as computer-mediated communication (CMC) and is one of the more popular activities associated with CALL. CMC encompasses communication by email, bulletin boards, chat lines, within MOO (Multi-user domains, Object Oriented) environments and using social networking services such as Facebook and Twitter.
- CMC refers to a situation in which computer-based discussion may take place but without necessarily involving learning.
- It is common for teachers in different countries to create assignments for their students to communicate in a common target language. Every miscommunication and clarification is a language learning opportunity.

Email:

- Email is among the most popular uses of the Internet and presents many opportunities to enhance learning. From the teacher's perspective, one of the great advantages of email over some other forms of communication is the record of both one's own messages and the messages one receives.
- Using email, learners can communicate with peers, teachers and native speakers.
- Most email programs now come with rudimentary spelling checkers but teachers concerned about the quality of their students' writing may encourage them to compose their messages in a word-processing software program then copy and paste it into their email messages.

Net Pals:

- One informal use of email is for the establishment of email pen pals. Such pen pals or pen friends are sometimes called net pals. Ideally, net pal communication is between someone learning the target language and a native speaker of the target language living in the culture of the target language.
- In practice, however, both parties can find net pal relationships frustrating. Native speakers may feel they cannot communicate

effectively with the learner and may feel the learner has nothing to offer in return in the exchange.

- Net pals work best when both parties have extrinsic motivation (e.g., a common interest in football or visiting one another's countries) and where the language learner has good clarification strategies and/or the support of a language teacher.

Chat Lines:

A chat line is more technically known as Internet Relay Chat (IRC) and appears on-screen as a window that presents what the learner is writing in one pane while general discussion among other participants continues in another. Once the learner has completed a message and presses the send command, the message is queued and appears in the main pane as quickly as the modem and host computer allow.

Bulletin Boards:

Bulletin boards on which learners (both teachers and users) can post messages to be read later by others are built into some CALL environments and more general learning platforms such as Blackboard Vista. The advantage of bulletin boards over email is that the messages are shared with a broader community (a few select people, a class or the whole world) and comment can be more considered as readers have more time.

MOO, MUA, MUD, MUG, MUSH:

MOO, MUA, MUD, MUSH and MUG generally refer to the same thing (and are referred to hereafter as MOO), an online environment where moveable objects represent things and people.

- **MOO** objects may be photo-realistic 3-D manipulated models or 2-D flat representations. This environment is a synchronous online multi-user space, that is, action takes place in real time among several participants who put their characters into the same scene on a computer screen. These scenes are usually referred to as rooms and can have great visual interest.
- **MUDs** were originally developed in 1978 by Roy Trubshaw, a student at Essex University, for socializing and playing games online (particularly versions of Dungeons and Dragons). Richard Bartle developed the game and helped to promote it internationally. A version of the game is still available at the commercial website CompuServe.

- The advantages of such environments to learning a language is that a learner can enter into an environment where a target language is being spoken and he or she is forced to react to others' words and actions.

World Wide Web Resources:

- The WWW has also presented opportunities for the creation of commercial websites dedicated to the teaching and learning of English. Such sites may have different foci in terms of age, level or even profession. For example, websites for improving business writing are popular.
- Many such websites are driven by commercial concerns. Typically, the learner pays a fee for enrolling and taking online lessons or endures advertising, much of which will be targeted at the learners by, for example, textbook publishers, language schools and language testing services.
- Many websites, especially those associated with government and non-profit organizations, such as Greenpeace (www.greenpeace.org) create associated websites to cater to students and language learners.

Adapting other Materials for CALL:

- . Many games and simulations not intended for language learning can be adapted for such a purpose, particularly for advanced learners, as they are likely to be rich in authentic language.
- Many other materials on the WWW are easy to adapt for classroom learning and offer a rich source of authentic text, images, sound and video.
- Virtual treasure hunts are activities in which the teacher assigns learners to collect images or explanations on a variety of topics. The purpose of the treasure hunt is not so much to find the answers but to expose learners to the target language in the course of the hunt.

Personal Digital Assistants (PDAs) and Mobile Telephones:

A Personal Digital Assistant (PDA) is a small hand-held computer for downloading and storing information such as documents, databases and calendar entries. It is less powerful than a desktop or laptop computer, but less expensive and more portable. PDAs have largely been replaced in the marketplace with mobile telephones that share many of the same functions and often feature Internet connectivity.

Teaching and Learning with Mobile Telephones:

PDAs and mobile telephones are not yet widely used in education, but their portability and expense could make them a popular choice in classrooms, especially when combined with accessories such as collapsible keyboards, digital cameras and modems that allow for WWW and email access. PDAs can only work with specially adapted files.

Graffiti Handwriting Software:

- In Ray Bradbury's (1958) collection of science-fiction short stories, The Martian Chronicles, one tale tells of a man who finds an alien's deserted home that miraculously adapts to his needs for water and shelter.
- In the absence of a keyboard, a major challenge to PDAs has been recognition of handwriting. Early models struggled to recognize individual handwriting but the creators of the Graffiti system realized it would be easier to make users adapt their handwriting to the PDA.
- Graffiti used modified and simplified punctuation, numbers and upper-case letters. Each character had to be unconnected; one could not write on the screen without lifting the stylus between letters.
- The future success of PDAs and mobile phone devices will depend on their ability to accommodate reliable and convenient voice recognition and to remain significantly less expensive than laptop computers.

MODULE 10:

CALL AND SECOND LANGUAGE ACQUISITION- I

Second-Language Acquisition (SLA):

Second-Language Acquisition (SLA) refers to the study of the processes through which learners acquire a new language.

Negotiation of Meaning:

- Nunan (1993) offers a concise definition of negotiation of meaning, 'The interactional work done by speakers and listeners to ensure they have a common understanding of the ongoing meanings of the discourse.
- Essentially, if two learners are assigned a so-called second-language collaborative task and do not need to communicate, they are often in agreement about how to complete the task and probably do not need to collaborate.
- A computer program can provide a high level of comprehensible input in various media.
- Negotiation of meaning and collaboration can occur regardless of the program; ironically, some of the worst software programs may present

more opportunities for SLA as learners struggle – and discuss their struggles – to make sense of the content and interface.

T. Pica on theory in SLA:

- Since its inception, the field of second-language acquisition (SLA) has been both theory-less and theory-laden. It has been theory-less in that, as most major textbooks remind us, there has yet to emerge a single, coherent theory that can describe, explain and predict second-language learning.
- Yet it is theory-laden in that there are at least forty claims, arguments, theories, and perspectives that attempt to describe and explain the learning process and predict its outcomes (see Larsen Freeman and Long, 1991 p. 227).

Bailin on why SLA theory can still be considered to be in its infancy:

- Bailin (1995) suggests that an SLA theory may be possible, but hints that it may need to incorporate so many variables as to make it too general to be of use. And, although we may observe what goes on in the language classroom and try to interpret those observations in theory and models of instruction, the rules that learners are internalizing may neither be visible nor fixed.
- In terms of CALL, the individualization of instruction makes for even greater opportunities for SLA to be promoted through software designs that assess learners' learning styles and track learners' acquisition through tests which remember and revisit individual items with which each learner has difficulty.

Comprehensible Input and Output:

One of the key contentions within SLA is the role of comprehensible input and comprehensible output. These terms are explained and discussed in the following section.

- Comprehensible input is an idea that originated with Terrell and Krashen (Krashen, 1981; Krashen and Terrell, 1983) but several others, including Ellis (1985), have defined it in their own ways.

Ellis on comprehensible input:

- When native speakers speak to L2 learners, they frequently adjust their speech to make it more comprehensible. Access to comprehensible input may be a necessary condition for acquisition to take place.

- However, Ellis (1994) notes that Krashen did not see comprehensible input coming from other learners, 'Interaction also provides learners with the opportunity to talk in the L2.
- Swain (1983) calls learner output, comprehensible output, and suggests that it is not enough for learners to see and hear language in use; to truly understand they need to have opportunities to use the target language.

A.B.M. Tsui on comprehensible output:

When students respond to the teacher's or their fellow students' questions, raise queries and give comments, they are actively involved in the negotiation of comprehensible input, which is essential to language acquisition. Swain (1985) points out that the production of comprehensible output is also essential to the acquisition of the target language.

D. Nunan on comprehensible input:

- According to Krashen's Comprehensible Input Hypothesis, acquisition occurs when learners' under-stand messages that are just beyond their current stage of development.
- In terms of CALL, Krashen (cited in Kenning and Kenning, 1990) describes optimal input for acquisition as having four characteristics:

1. It is comprehensible

2. It is interesting and/or relevant to the acquirer

3. It is not grammatically sequenced

4. It is provided in sufficient quantity

- CALL can generally deal with all of these criteria, including adding a wide range of extralinguistic clues through sound, images, animation and video. Such decisions are relatively simple for a well-trained teacher to make, but can be difficult for a computer.
- Three ways in which computer programs deal with this problem are:
  - by offering learner-prompted extra-linguistic elements as clues;
  - by having learners select their own level of comprehension;
  - and/or through Computer-Adaptive Testing (CAT) in which the learner is directed along easier or more difficult tasks or links depending on answers to questions at key points of the program.

Computer-Adaptive Testing (CAT):

- Computer-Adaptive Testing (CAT) uses a database of questions to match the difficulty of each test item to the abilities of the learners being tested.
- One of the great advantages of CAT is that randomization of test items can ensure that learners of a large class taking a test in the same room may all take slightly different tests as their correct and incorrect answers prompt the computer to take them to different levels.

Oxford on comprehensible input:

The concept that any single methodology focusing on fluency at the expense of accuracy can apply to all students, such as the Natural Approach of Krashen and Terrell (1983), must be seriously questioned.

MODULE 11:

CALL AND SECOND LANGUAGE ACQUISITION- II

P. Lai and J. Biggs on mastery learning:

Mastery learning is based on the assumption that learning is a function of time (Bloom, Hastings and Madaus, 1971; Carroll, 1963). In theory, by varying time for learning, nearly all students are able to learn a subject to the point of 'mastery' (Gus key, 1985). In implementing mastery learning, it is thus necessary to establish a criterion, and to provide corrective instruction in the event of failure.

C.T. Fosnot on mastery learning:

- This model assumes that wholes can be broken into parts, that skills can be broken into subskills. Learners are diagnosed in terms of deficiencies, called 'needs', then taught until 'mastery' – defined as behavioral competence – is achieved at each level.
- The challenge of mastery learning in CALL is the necessity of providing new material or new approaches when a learner fails to accomplish the initial goals.
- Learner motivation is a key consideration in the creation of CALL materials many of which, like electronic versions of Pressey's mechanical candy-dispensing testing machine, are set up as adventure games or include positive reinforcement in the form of points, and virtual items to be collected by the learner/player.
- Mastery learning also tends to assume that, once a learner has demonstrated the ability to answer a question or complete a task, he or she knows it forever.

- Behaviorist machines, mechanical, electric and electronic, in the form of computers, are suited to the strict guidelines set down by the behaviorist model of instruction. In a behaviorist model, the software program or teacher – not the learner – is assumed to be the expert and the source of the learning materials.

Constructivism:

- Constructivism is a humanistic model that differs radically from behaviorism, suggesting that learning is a process by which learners construct new ideas or concepts by making use of their own knowledge and experiences.
- In a constructivist model, the learner is assumed to come to the class-room with a range of experiences and a wealth of (sometimes imperfect) knowledge.

M. Pennington on the components of an ideal teaching system:

• Allows learners to learn according to their own purposes and goals

• Puts learners in touch with other learners

• Promotes cultural and social learning

• Promotes interactivity in learning and communication

• Exposes the learner to appropriate contexts for learning

Schema Theory:

- Schema theory is important to CALL because it provides an idea of how knowledge is organized. Psychologist F.C. Bartlett (1886 –1969) first proposed the idea of schema theory in 1932.
- Nunan (1993) defines schema theory as 'A theory of language processing which suggests that discourse is interpreted with reference to the background knowledge of the reader or listener.
- Nunan also notes 'schema theory suggests that the knowledge we carry around in our heads is organized into interrelated patterns.

T.G. Anderson helps to define a schema approach to teaching and learning:

- Anderson (1988) notes that among the differences between experts and novices is the fact that an expert will break down new information into more relevant chunks than a novice will and an expert has more knowledge to which it may be connected.

- Two common ways of creating such schematic maps are word association (e.g. making semantic connections) and pattern noting (examining ideas and the real world and drawing inferences about the relationships).
- Schema theory is important to CALL because many aspects of schema mirror the organization of hypertext, hypermedia and multimedia.

A. Dillon, C. McKnight and J. Richardson suggest that:

While Dillon et al. (1993) draw parallels between interface and schema building, they also suggest that hypertext alone is not sufficient to help learners in their acquisition of a second language, although it may help them process tasks.

Example: Mind Map Software

Mind maps are visual representations of schemata. They are usually presented as a series of branching lines radiating from a central circle containing the main idea. The lines terminate in circles of related ideas which may branch off to further ideas. These programs provide templates to build on as well as a variety of tools in the form of symbols and shapes to help build mind maps.

My Family

"Just Relax and focus! Exams are not difficult. Put in your 100% effort and trust in Allah.

AL-Quran

"And indeed, with hardship comes ease." (Quran 94:5)

Remember, I'm here to support you! Stay brave and strong!"

May Allah bless you

ZB Family:

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https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029VaODheTDp2Q8YVcoON2p

Second WhatsApp Channel:

💌🖌️***VIRTUAL SQUAD DAILY UPDATES***🔮

https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029VafvOcy90x2tPbUaX02I

YouTube Video for How to summarize long handouts in few minutes:

https://youtu.be/-AMj4iNz0UE?si=hg29pJZ1kujzg57J

Letter Grade	Grade Points	Equivalent Percentage
A+	4.00	90-100
A	4.00	85-89
A-	3.66 - 3.99	80-84
B+	3.33 - 3.65	75-79
B	3.00 - 3.32	71-74
B-	2.66 - 2.99	68-70
C	2.00 - 2.65	61-67
D	1.00 - 1.99	50-60
F	0.00	00-49

Passing Criteria for a Course

The passing criteria is defined in such a way that it ensures the student shall be consistent in his studies throughout the semester. Therefore, for passing a course/subject, student shall fulfill the following:

a) Secure minimum 20% score in Formative Assessments/Mid terms

b) Secure minimum 20% score in Final Term Examinations.

c) Secure at least 40% marks in aggregate while fulfilling the above requirements

Course Selection and Credit Hours

Q: How do I select courses when the course selection is open?

A: Follow these steps:

1. Check the credit hours allowed by your university (e.g., 21, 18, or 15 credit hours).

2. Each subject typically has 3 credit hours.

3. Divide the total allowed credit hours by 3 to determine how many subjects you can select.

Examples:

21 credit hours = 7 subjects

18 credit hours = 6 subjects

15 credit hours = 5 subjects

Remember, the university may allow different credit hours for each student, so check your specific allowance.

By following these steps, you can make informed decisions during course selection and manage your credit hours effectively.

ZB